

Caribe Sur

Costa Rica · southern Caribbean coast · **Mon 5 – Sat 10 October 2026**

Jason & Andrea · Cahuita to Manzanillo · 32 entries, 30 activities

HOME BASES

MON 5 – WED 7 OCT

Dragonfly Beach Retreat — Deluxe Casita

Home base for the nights of Oct 5 and 6 (out Oct 7). Deluxe Casita, confirmation 4W9K5ZP4QB, paid in full.

- Check-in Oct 5 15:00, check-out Oct 7 11:00
- 100 m from Playa Arrecife and La Sirena
- Ask about on-site couples massage and bikes

Phone / WhatsApp +506 6128 7817

WED 7 – SAT 10 OCT

Congo Bongo EcoVillage — Sweet Dream House

Home base for Oct 7–10. Sweet Dream House, locator 33643575, \$419.51 due at the property.

- Office 07:00–16:00; after 16:00 keys are in the lockbox
- Five minutes on foot to the Gandoca-Manzanillo refuge trail
- Daan can book Sherman's boat directly

Phone / WhatsApp +506 8957 4177

NUMBERS TO HAVE ON PAPER

Dragonfly Beach Retreat	+506 6128 7817	Conf.	4W9K5ZP4QB · paid in full
Congo Bongo — Daan Nelemans	+506 8957 4177	Locator	33643575 · \$419.51 due at property
Adobe Rent a Car, Limón	+506 2758 4042	Car	Pick up Mon 13:30 · return Sat 15:30, full tank (closes 17:00)
Sansa — Limón (LIO)	RZ1102 / RZ1132	Flights	Mon 12:40 arrive · Sat 17:10 depart to SJO
Other numbers	Jaguar Rescue +506 2750 0710 · Kayaks Punta Uva +506 8839 8386 · Beauty Ritual Spa +506 8314 8943 · Green Water Tours +506 6427 7088 · Cacao Trails +506 8353 8455 · Finca la Isla +506 8886 8530		

SIX DAYS AT A GLANCE

DATE	SLEEP	FIXED POINTS	OPTION SETS
Mon Oct 5	Dragonfly	12:40 Land Limón (Sansa RZ1102) 13:30 Adobe Rent a Car pickup 15:00 Dragonfly check-in	Land and float · Stretch the legs
Tue Oct 6	Dragonfly	Open day	Water day · Sloths first · Slow day
Wed Oct 7	Congo Bongo	11:00 Dragonfly checkout 16:00 Congo Bongo office closes	Cocles morning · Cahuita today instead of Saturday · Straight to Manzanillo
Thu Oct 8	Congo Bongo	Open day	Boat day · Hike day · Do both
Fri Oct 9	Congo Bongo	Open day	Waterfall + chocolate · Puerto Viejo only · Stay south
Sat Oct 10	Congo Bongo	07:00 Settle \$419.51 with Congo Bongo 15:30 Adobe return — Limón downtown 16:15 Sansa check-in (LIO) 17:10 Sansa RZ1132 to SJO	Cahuita snorkel + walk · Cahuita walk only · Slow exit

DON'T FORGET

- **TUE OCT 6** La NENA is closed today (Tue).
- **WED OCT 7** La NENA is closed today (Wed).
- **FRI OCT 9** Inland options are ~35 min from Manzanillo.
- **SAT OCT 10** All bags are in the car at Cahuita — paid lot at Kelly Creek, nothing visible.
- **SAT OCT 10** Latest departure from Manzanillo direct to Limón: 13:45.
- **SAT OCT 10** Saturday hours differ: Moca Beach closes 17:00, Rios Vegan closes 12:00.
- **EVERY DAY** Carry cash — card machines are unreliable (Moca Beach, Ma-Cu, Two Waters, kayak rental are cash).
- **BOOK AHEAD** Cahuita reef snorkel (24 h), Sherman's boat (ask Daan the day before), couples massage (WhatsApp a day ahead).

Part I • The coast, north to south

KEY • Nature ◊ Water ◆ Culture ▲ Wellness ◇ Town ■ Eat Drive times are estimates: straight-line distance × 1.3, at 30 km/h.

01 Cahuita

~47 min from Dragonfly / ~56 min from Congo Bongo | 3 entries

NATURE • WATER

• **Cahuita National Park — coastal trail** NATURE

Donation, \$5–10 pp suggested · 2–4 h · No booking needed

HOURS Daily 08:00–16:00 | **BEST** Oct 7, Oct 10

Flat 8 km trail from Kelly Creek (Cahuita village) to Puerto Vargas along the beach and through jungle; the last stretch is a raised boardwalk.

- Sloths, howler and capuchin monkeys
- Raccoons that raid bags
- Punta Cahuita white-sand beach halfway

Note: On a transit day, walk 45–60 min in and turn around. Park in the paid lot by Kelly Creek and leave nothing visible — bags will be in the car.

BOOKING None; guides at the Kelly Creek gate ~\$25 pp

PAIRS WITH Cahuita National Park — reef snorkel by boat; Cahuita village

◊ **Cahuita National Park — reef snorkel by boat** WATER

\$45–55 pp, gear + fruit included · 2–2.5 h · **Book ahead** — Book 24 h ahead

HOURS Daily 08:00–12:00 | **BEST** Oct 7, Oct 10

Ten-minute boat to two reef spots inside the park's 600-hectare marine zone, then a fruit break on Punta Cahuita beach.

- Costa Rica's largest Caribbean reef
- Sea turtles, rays, nurse sharks on the sand, parrotfish
- Sep–Oct is peak visibility

Note: Snorkeling here is guided-only. Conditions can cancel it the morning of — have the walk as plan B. Re-enter the park free after the boat. Tours at 08:15 and mid-morning.

BOOKING Required — guided only. Cahuita Experience meets 08:15 at their shop; Wildlife Tours CR \$45 + \$20 pp optional pickup from Manzanillo; Green Cahuita on GetYourGuide (\$49). | W wildlifetours.cr

PAIRS WITH Cahuita National Park — coastal trail; Cahuita village

CULTURE • WELLNESS • TOWN

◇ **Cahuita village** TOWN

1 h · No booking needed

HOURS Daily open all day | **BEST** Oct 10

Sleepy Afro-Caribbean village at the park gate: reggae bars, sodas serving rice-and-beans, one main street.

- Lunch after the park
- The last Caribbean stop before Limón

PAIRS WITH Cahuita National Park — coastal trail; Cahuita National Park — reef snorkel by boat

02 Hone Creek / Bribri

~32 min from Dragonfly / ~42 min from Congo Bongo | 5 entries

NATURE · WATER

• Catarata Finca Two Waters NATURE

~\$4 pp cash · 1.5 h · No booking needed

HOURS Daily 08:00–17:00 | **BEST** Oct 9

Two waterfalls on a family finca 2 km past Hone Creek on the Bribri road.

- Deep pool with a jump rock on the lower fall
- Lookout over Puerto Viejo and the coast
- Usually empty before 10:00

Note: 1 km steep driveway (fine in the Vitara), then 20–30 min muddy downhill walk; bring water. Cash.

PAIRS WITH Cacao Trails — Museo de Cacao; Kekoldi indigenous family — cacao and exotic animals | **OR** Catarata Ma-Cu (Bribri "Sparkling" waterfall)

• Catarata Ma-Cu (Bribri "Sparkling" waterfall) NATURE

Ø2,500 pp, includes coffee and fruit · 1 h · No booking needed

HOURS Daily 08:00–17:00 | **BEST** Oct 9

Family-run falls halfway to Bribri.

- Ten-minute walk down
- Welcoming family
- Coffee and fruit included

Note: Steep and slippery; arrive early for parking at the house. Skip Volio — guided-only and security warnings.

BOOKING None; drive up the family's driveway off Route 36

PAIRS WITH Cacao Trails — Museo de Cacao; Kekoldi indigenous family — cacao and exotic animals | **OR** Catarata Finca Two Waters

CULTURE · WELLNESS · TOWN

◆ Cacao Trails — Museo de Cacao CULTURE

~\$30–35 pp · 2 h · No booking needed

HOURS Daily 08:00–16:00 | **BEST** Oct 9

Working cacao garden and small museum at Hone Creek.

- Bean-to-bar walk
- Bribri history
- Wildlife on the property
- You make and taste the chocolate at the end

Note: Ten minutes from the Two Waters turnoff.

BOOKING WhatsApp; ask for Daniel | T +506 8353 8455

PAIRS WITH Catarata Finca Two Waters; Catarata Ma-Cu (Bribri "Sparkling" waterfall); Finca la Isla permaculture farm and botanical garden | **OR** Kekoldi indigenous family — cacao and exotic animals

◆ Kekoldi indigenous family — cacao and exotic animals CULTURE

Ask · 2 h · **Book ahead** — Confirm by phone before driving

HOURS By arrangement | **BEST** Oct 9

Small Bribri family operation near Hone Creek: the whole cacao process through to a thick chocolate drink, plus the animals they keep.

- Personal, few visitors

Note: Only two public reviews — confirm by phone before driving. Spanish.

BOOKING Call/WhatsApp (Spanish) | T +506 8580 5253

PAIRS WITH Catarata Finca Two Waters; Catarata Ma-Cu (Bribri "Sparkling" waterfall) | **OR** Cacao Trails — Museo de Cacao; Kekoldi Reserve — chocolate + waterfall tour (backup)

◆ **Kekoldi Reserve — chocolate + waterfall tour (backup)** CULTURE

From ~\$75 pp · 4–6 h · **Book ahead** — Book online the day before

HOURS Daily 08:00–14:00 | **BEST** Oct 9

Guided version if the family doesn't answer: iguana conservation project, medicinal plants, chocolate, waterfall swim, Caribbean lunch.

- Iguana conservation project
- Medicinal plants and chocolate
- Waterfall swim and Caribbean lunch

Note: Tours ~08:00. Backup only if kekoldi-cacao doesn't answer.

BOOKING Viator / Musement "Indigenous Reserve Chocolate and Waterfalls" | W viator.com/searchResults/all

OR Kekoldi indigenous family — cacao and exotic animals; Cacao Trails — Museo de Cacao

03 **Puerto Viejo**

~18 min from Dragonfly / ~28 min from Congo Bongo | 6 entries

NATURE · WATER

● **Finca la Isla permaculture farm and botanical garden** NATURE

~\$8 self-guided; guided by arrangement · 1.5–2 h · No booking needed

HOURS Mon 10:00–16:00 · Tue–Thu closed · Fri–Sun 10:00–16:00 | **BEST** Oct 5, Oct 9

Spice, fruit, and medicinal-plant garden on the Playa Negra side of Puerto Viejo.

- Vanilla, nutmeg, cinnamon
- Fruit tasting at the end
- Red poison-dart frogs, sloths and toucans on the property

Note: Mud shoes; signs on the self-guided route are faded, so a guide is worth it. Closed Tue–Thu.

BOOKING Call a day ahead for a guided walk | T +506 8886 8530

PAIRS WITH Grow Puerto Viejo; bread what what; La NENA

EAT

■ **Grow Puerto Viejo** EAT

\$\$ · No booking needed

HOURS Mon–Sat 12:00–21:00 · Sun closed | **BEST** Oct 9

Vegetarian/vegan on the Puerto Viejo waterfront.

- Mushroom tacos
- Falafel salad
- Carrot-lox bruschetta
- Smoothies, sea view

Note: Closed Sunday.

PAIRS WITH Finca la Isla permaculture farm and botanical garden; bread what what

■ **Rios Vegan Food** EAT

\$ · No booking needed

HOURS Mon–Fri 08:00–16:00 · Sat 07:00–12:00 · Sun closed | **BEST** Oct 9

Tiny vegan counter in Puerto Viejo.

- Hand-pie empanadas (~€1,800; lentil bolognese, Indian-spiced)
- Croissants
- Banana cake

Note: Takeout — grab for a hike. Sat 07:00–12:00 only; closed Sunday.

PAIRS WITH Catarata Finca Two Waters; Catarata Ma-Cu (Bribri "Sparkling" waterfall); bread what what

■ bread what what EAT

\$\$ · No booking needed

HOURS Mon 08:00–15:00 · Tue closed · Wed–Fri 08:00–15:00 · Sat–Sun 08:00–16:00 | **BEST** Oct 9

Puerto Viejo brunch café.

- Huge sandwiches, banana waffles, açai
- No-sugar juices, strong coffee
- Sloths sometimes visible from the tables

Note: Closed Tuesday. Closes 15:00 on weekdays, 16:00 on weekends.

PAIRS WITH Rios Vegan Food; Finca la Isla permaculture farm and botanical garden; Grow Puerto Viejo

■ Restaurante El Dragon — Asian cuisine & Kung Fu Bar EAT

\$\$ · No booking needed

HOURS Daily 17:00–22:00 | **BEST** Oct 5, Oct 9

Pan-Asian dinner spot on the coast road just past Salsa Brava in Puerto Viejo, with cocktails and kung-fu movies playing in the bar.

4.7★ on Tripadvisor.

- Handmade dumplings and gyoza (veggie ones are the favorite)
- Pad Thai reviewers call the best of their trip
- Fried rice, edamame, sweet-chili veggies
- Vegetarian dishes made vegan on request

Note: Dinner only, opens ~17:00. 200 m south of Super Diamante, after Salsa Brava, left side. Pin and hours are from web listings, not verified on the ground — confirm by phone. Small room; go early.

BOOKING Walk in; call to confirm hours | T +506 6095 4940 · W [instagram.com/thedragon.pv](https://www.instagram.com/thedragon.pv)

PAIRS WITH Finca la Isla permaculture farm and botanical garden; bread what what | **OR** Umi Rojo Beach House (ex-Chile Rojo); Grow Puerto Viejo; La NENA

■ Umi Rojo Beach House (ex-Chile Rojo) EAT

\$\$ · No booking needed

HOURS Mon 17:00–22:00 · Tue closed · Wed 17:00–22:00 · Thu–Fri 17:00–23:00 · Sat–Sun 12:00–23:00 | **BEST** Oct 9

Oceanfront Thai–Japanese fusion with a sushi bar on Puerto Viejo's main street, next to KOKi Beach. Appears to be the long-running Chile Rojo under a new name.

- Sushi rolls and sampler platters with local fish
- Thai seafood soup, sea bass in shrimp-coconut sauce
- Handmade gyoza, Korean wings, dynamite shrimp
- Strong vegan and gluten-free menu
- 2-for-1 cocktail promo most nights

Note: Chile Rojo hours were: closed Tue, dinner-only weekdays, lunch too Sat & Sun. Hours may have changed with the rebrand — call first. Skip the Monday all-you-can-eat buffet night: quality and wait times drop. Main-street location, no dedicated parking.

BOOKING Walk in; call to confirm hours and name | T +506 2750 0421 · W [facebook.com/p/Chile-Rojo-100063453198523](https://www.facebook.com/p/Chile-Rojo-100063453198523)

PAIRS WITH Finca la Isla permaculture farm and botanical garden; Grow Puerto Viejo | **OR** Restaurante El Dragon — Asian cuisine & Kung Fu Bar; Grow Puerto Viejo

04 Playa Chiquita

~9 min from Dragonfly / ~18 min from Congo Bongo | 1 entry

EAT

■ Spicy Coconut EAT

\$\$ · No booking needed

HOURS Daily 12:30–21:30 | **BEST** Oct 6, Oct 7

Beachfront Caribbean-fusion restaurant and cocktail terrace inside Hotel Villas del Caribe in Playa Chiquita, directly across the road from the Jaguar Rescue Center. 4.5★ from 159 reviews.

- Poke bowls, Thai coconut curry, coconut shrimp
- Spicy ceviche and avocado lomito tacos
- Polynesian hot wings, margaritas at sunset
- Sloths in the almond tree over the terrace
- Small boutique of local handmade goods

Note: Lunch and dinner, 12:30–21:30; closed days not published — call to confirm. Busy on weekend nights; reserve by phone. Hotel parking. The natural lunch after the 09:30 Jaguar Rescue tour.

BOOKING Reservations by phone | T +506 2201 7849 · W spicy-coconut.com

PAIRS WITH Jaguar Rescue Center; Masajes Beauty Ritual Spa — couples massage | **OR** La Sirena; SAGE @ Playa 506; Pita & Hummus House

05 Cocles

~10 min from Dragonfly / ~20 min from Congo Bongo | 6 entries

NATURE · WATER

• Jaguar Rescue Center NATURE

~\$24 pp · 2 h · No booking needed

HOURS Daily 09:00–13:00 | **BEST** Oct 6, Oct 7

Wildlife rescue and rehab center in Cocles; small guided groups walk you past sloths, monkeys, toucans, snakes, with each animal's story.

- Guaranteed close sloths
- Volunteers are excellent
- Money goes to releases

Note: Bring repellent; tip the guide. Ten minutes from Dragonfly. Tours at 09:30 and 11:30.

BOOKING Walk in, or reserve online | T +506 2750 0710 · W jaguarrescue.foundation

PAIRS WITH La Sirena; SAGE @ Playa 506; Pita & Hummus House

CULTURE · WELLNESS · TOWN

▲ Masajes Beauty Ritual Spa — couples massage WELLNESS

~\$70 pp / 70 min · 1.5 h · **Book ahead** — WhatsApp a day ahead

HOURS Daily 08:00–21:00 | **BEST** Oct 6, Oct 8

Cocles studio on Calle Ole Caribe, 5.0★ from 110 reviews.

- Couples room
- Foot bath and cold chocolate on arrival
- Chocolate facial at the end
- Reviewers call it the best massage of their trip

Note: Ask about a beach setup vs. studio. Same street as Zaika — pair them.

BOOKING WhatsApp | T +506 8314 8943

PAIRS WITH Zaika Indian Cuisine Bar & Grill

EAT

■ La NENA EAT

\$\$ · No booking needed

HOURS Mon 12:00–20:30 · Tue–Wed closed · Thu–Sun 12:00–20:30 | **BEST** Oct 5, Oct 8, Oct 9

Roadside Caribbean in Cocles.

- Chicken thighs with coconut rice-and-beans
- Oxtail
- Shrimp rice
- House hot sauce

Note: Closed Tue and Wed — Monday night is the natural slot. Vegetarian options are thin.

PAIRS WITH Finca la Isla permaculture farm and botanical garden

■ Zaika Indian Cuisine Bar & Grill EAT

\$\$ · No booking needed

HOURS Mon–Sat 12:00–22:00 · Sun closed | **BEST** Oct 6, Oct 8

Open-kitchen Indian on Calle Ole Caribe.

- Mixed grill
- Fish curry
- Shahi paneer
- Real heat on request, vegan-friendly

Note: Next to the spa. Closed Sunday.

PAIRS WITH Masajes Beauty Ritual Spa — couples massage

■ Pita & Hummus House EAT

\$\$ · No booking needed

HOURS Mon–Sat 07:00–21:00 · Sun closed | **BEST** Oct 7, Oct 8

Family Lebanese on Route 256.

- Homemade falafel, tabbouleh, lamb kebab
- Mojitos
- Strong vegan options
- Parking on site

Note: Closed Sunday.

PAIRS WITH Jaguar Rescue Center

■ SAGE @ Playa 506 EAT

\$\$ · No booking needed

HOURS Daily 08:00–21:00 | **BEST** Oct 7

Beer garden built around a tree on Playa Cocles, sand floor, hammocks.

- The setting
- Avocado toast and juices at breakfast
- A place to sit on the beach with a drink

Note: Food reviews are mixed — go for the spot.

PAIRS WITH Jaguar Rescue Center; Masajes Beauty Ritual Spa — couples massage

06 Punta Uva

~1 min (walkable) from Dragonfly / ~9 min from Congo Bongo | 3 entries

NATURE · WATER

◦ **Río Punta Uva kayak + sloth walk** WATER

Rental ~\$10 pp/h cash; guided ~\$50–76 pp · 1–2.5 h · No booking needed

HOURS Daily 08:00–17:00 | **BEST** Oct 6

Paddle up the river that meets the sea at Punta Uva point.

- Sloths, toucans, iguanas, turtles at water level
- Guides add a short walk to the point lookout
- Walking distance from Dragonfly

Note: Go at 08:00 for wildlife and before the wind. Rental is cash.

BOOKING Rental: Kayaks Punta Uva +506 8839 8386. Guided: Green Water Tours +506 6427 7088 (Playa Arrecife), Pachos Place +506 6009 1870. | T +506 8839 8386

PAIRS WITH DIY snorkel at Playa Arrecife / Punta Uva point; La Sirena

◦ **DIY snorkel at Playa Arrecife / Punta Uva point** WATER

Gear rental ~\$5–10/day · 1 h · No booking needed

HOURS Daily 06:00–17:30 | **BEST** Oct 6

Shore snorkel around the rocks at the point on a calm morning.

- No boat, no guide, ten minutes from the casita
- La Sirena lunch afterward

Note: Only worth it when the sea is flat.

BOOKING Rent gear from Green Water Tours at Arrecife | T +506 6427 7088

PAIRS WITH La Sirena; Río Punta Uva kayak + sloth walk

EAT

■ **La Sirena** EAT

\$\$ · No booking needed

HOURS Mon–Sat 11:00–17:00 · Sun closed | **BEST** Oct 6

On Playa Arrecife, 100 m from Dragonfly. Lunch on a tray on the sand.

- Peruvian-style ceviche (fish or vegetarian)
- Catch of the day in white-wine chimichurri butter
- Spicy shrimp
- They hand you a tray to eat on the sand

Note: Lunch only. Closed Sunday.

PAIRS WITH DIY snorkel at Playa Arrecife / Punta Uva point; Río Punta Uva kayak + sloth walk; Jaguar Rescue Center

07 Manzanillo

~11 min from Dragonfly / ~2 min (walkable) from Congo Bongo | 6 entries

NATURE · WATER

• **Gandoca-Manzanillo Wildlife Refuge trail** NATURE

Donation · 1.5–4 h · No booking needed

HOURS Daily 06:30–15:00 | **BEST** Oct 8, Oct 9, Oct 10

Trail from Manzanillo village south along cliffs to hidden coves; Playa Bite at ~1.5 km, Punta Mona at ~5 km.

- Sloths, howlers, poison-dart frogs
- Clifftop viewpoint
- Empty beaches for a swim

Note: Mud — real shoes. Five minutes on foot from Congo Bongo. A 06:30 start on Oct 10 still leaves time for Cahuita.

BOOKING Optional guide at the entrance (~\$30–40 pp) or via Congo Bongo's Caribe Fun Tours link

PAIRS WITH DIY snorkel off Manzanillo beach; Moca Beach Restaurant; Maxi's Restaurant (Manzanillo)

◦ **Sherman's Boat Tour — dolphins, Punta Mona, snorkel** WATER

\$85–110 pp · 3–4 h · **Book ahead** — Ask Daan the day before

HOURS Daily 07:30–17:00 | **BEST** Oct 8, Oct 9

Launch from Manzanillo beach, search for bottlenose and tucuxi dolphins off Gandoca (~85–90% sighting), then a beach break at Punta Mona with snorkeling on the point when conditions allow.

- Punta Mona is boat-or-3-hour-hike only, so you have it nearly alone
- Fresh fruit and pipa on the sand
- The reef has reef sharks and gorges

Note: No pier — you climb in from the beach. Ask him to include the Punta Mona farm walk. Departures ~08:00 and ~13:00.

BOOKING Required. Ask Daan at Congo Bongo to book Sherman directly; backup Rico Tico / Sulariwäk on GetYourGuide (meets by the Manzanillo soccer field). | T +506 8957 4177

PAIRS WITH Punta Mona permaculture farm; Maxi's Restaurant (Manzanillo)

◦ **DIY snorkel off Manzanillo beach** WATER

Gear rental ~\$5–10 · 1 h · No booking needed

HOURS Daily 06:00–17:30 | **BEST** Oct 8, Oct 9

Shallow reef right in front of the village.

- Walk from Congo Bongo
- No booking

Note: Calm mornings only.

BOOKING Rent gear in the village

PAIRS WITH Gandoca-Manzanillo Wildlife Refuge trail; Maxi's Restaurant (Manzanillo)

CULTURE · WELLNESS · TOWN

◆ **Punta Mona permaculture farm** CULTURE

Included in boat combos · 1 h · **Book ahead**

HOURS By arrangement | **BEST** Oct 8

Hundred-acre off-grid farm behind Punta Mona beach.

- Fruit tasting from the orchard
- The story of the place

Note: Do not plan a separate hike-in visit. Only reachable as an add-on to Sherman's boat.

BOOKING Only as an add-on to Sherman's boat; standalone public visits appear dormant

PAIRS WITH Sherman's Boat Tour — dolphins, Punta Mona, snorkel

EAT

■ **Moca Beach Restaurant** EAT

\$\$ · No booking needed

HOURS Mon–Fri 07:00–21:00 · Sat 09:00–17:00 · Sun 07:00–21:00 | **BEST** Oct 7, Oct 8, Oct 9

Jungle-hotel restaurant 2 km before Manzanillo with a path to its own beach.

- Casados, octopus, chicken patacones
- Coconut flan, cocktails
- Monkeys on the beach path

Note: Carry cash — the card machine is unreliable. Sat closes 17:00.

PAIRS WITH Gandoca-Manzanillo Wildlife Refuge trail; DIY snorkel off Manzanillo beach

■ **Maxi's Restaurant (Manzanillo)** EAT

\$\$ · No booking needed

HOURS Daily 11:00–21:00 | **BEST** Oct 8, Oct 9

The village institution by the beach — whole red snapper, lobster, rondón.

- Whole red snapper, lobster, rondón
- Walkable from Congo Bongo, so no driving after drinks

PAIRS WITH Sherman's Boat Tour — dolphins, Punta Mona, snorkel; Gandoca-Manzanillo Wildlife Refuge trail; DIY snorkel off Manzanillo beach

Part II · Day by day

NOTE Anchors are fixed. Option sets are alternatives — pick one, not all.

MON	Oct 5	DRAGONFLY, PUNTA UVA
12:40	Land Limón (Sansa RZ1102) Limón International Airport (LIO).	
13:30	Adobe Rent a Car pickup Bring passport, license, Fidelity card, ARCDW pages.	+506 2758 4042
15:00	Dragonfly check-in ~1h15 drive from Limón. Conf 4W9K5ZP4QB, paid in full.	+506 6128 7817

Land and float

Arrive, swim at Punta Uva beach, dinner at La NENA — the only night it's open before Thursday. El Dragon in town is the backup if you land hungry for Asian.

- La NENA [Cocles]
- Restaurante El Dragon — Asian cuisine & Kung Fu Bar [Puerto Viejo]

Stretch the legs

Finca la Isla on the way through Puerto Viejo (open Mon until 16:00 — tight after a 15:00 check-in, only if the car pickup is fast), then dinner at La NENA.

- Finca la Isla permaculture farm and botanical garden [Puerto Viejo]
- La NENA [Cocles]

TUE	Oct 6	DRAGONFLY, PUNTA UVA
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No fixed times today — the whole day is yours.

WATCH OUT La NENA is closed today (Tue).

Water day

Kayak at 08:00, snorkel the point, lunch on the sand at La Sirena, couples massage at 16:00, dinner at Zaika.

- Río Punta Uva kayak + sloth walk [Punta Uva]
- DIY snorkel at Playa Arrecife / Punta Uva point [Punta Uva]
- La Sirena [Punta Uva]
- ▲ Masajes Beauty Ritual Spa — couples massage [Cocles]
- Zaika Indian Cuisine Bar & Grill [Cocles]

Sloths first

Jaguar Rescue 09:30 tour, lunch at Spicy Coconut across the road (or back to La Sirena), afternoon kayak, dinner at Zaika or Pita & Hummus.

- Jaguar Rescue Center [Cocles]
- Spicy Coconut [Playa Chiquita]
- La Sirena [Punta Uva]
- Río Punta Uva kayak + sloth walk [Punta Uva]
- Zaika Indian Cuisine Bar & Grill [Cocles]
- Pita & Hummus House [Cocles]

Slow day

Bikes from Dragonfly to Playa Chiquita and Cocles, SAGE for a beach afternoon, massage, dinner at Zaika.

- SAGE @ Playa 506 [Cocles]
- ▲ Masajes Beauty Ritual Spa — couples massage [Cocles]
- Zaika Indian Cuisine Bar & Grill [Cocles]

11:00	Dragonfly checkout	+506 6128 7817
16:00	Congo Bongo office closes ~10 min drive from Dragonfly. After 16:00 keys are in the lockbox — confirm the code with Daan.	+506 8957 4177

WATCH OUT La NENA is closed today (Wed).

Cocles morning

Jaguar Rescue 09:30 (if not done Tue), lunch at Spicy Coconut, SAGE or Pita & Hummus, check in, dinner at Moca Beach.

1. ● Jaguar Rescue Center [Cocles]
2. ■ Spicy Coconut [Playa Chiquita]
3. ■ SAGE @ Playa 506 [Cocles]
4. ■ Pita & Hummus House [Cocles]
5. ■ Moca Beach Restaurant [Manzanillo]

Cahuita today instead of Saturday

Leave 07:15, snorkel at 08:15 and/or the coastal walk, lunch in Cahuita village, 50 min south to Congo Bongo before 16:00, dinner at Moca Beach. Frees Saturday for a slow morning.

1. ○ Cahuita National Park — reef snorkel by boat [Cahuita]
2. ● Cahuita National Park — coastal trail [Cahuita]
3. ◇ Cahuita village [Cahuita]
4. ■ Moca Beach Restaurant [Manzanillo]

Straight to Manzanillo

Check in early, short walk in the refuge (closes 15:00), swim, dinner at Moca Beach.

1. ● Gandoca-Manzanillo Wildlife Refuge trail [Manzanillo]
2. ■ Moca Beach Restaurant [Manzanillo]

No fixed times today — the whole day is yours.

Boat day

Sherman's boat at 08:00 with the Punta Mona farm add-on, slow afternoon, dinner at Pita & Hummus (25 min) or walk to Maxi's.

1. ○ Sherman's Boat Tour — dolphins, Punta Mona, snorkel [Manzanillo]
2. ◆ Punta Mona permaculture farm [Manzanillo]
3. ■ Pita & Hummus House [Cocles]
4. ■ Maxi's Restaurant (Manzanillo) [Manzanillo]

Hike day

Refuge trail to Playa Bite or Punta Mona from 06:30, snorkel off the village on the way back, lunch at Moca Beach, massage late afternoon, dinner at Zaika.

1. ● Gandoca-Manzanillo Wildlife Refuge trail [Manzanillo]
2. ○ DIY snorkel off Manzanillo beach [Manzanillo]
3. ■ Moca Beach Restaurant [Manzanillo]
4. ▲ Masajes Beauty Ritual Spa — couples massage [Cocles]
5. ■ Zaika Indian Cuisine Bar & Grill [Cocles]

Do both

Boat at 08:00, short refuge walk after lunch — be back by 15:00.

1. ○ Sherman's Boat Tour — dolphins, Punta Mona, snorkel [Manzanillo]
2. ■ Moca Beach Restaurant [Manzanillo]
3. ● Gandoca-Manzanillo Wildlife Refuge trail [Manzanillo]

No fixed times today — the whole day is yours.

WATCH OUT Inland options are ~35 min from Manzanillo.

Waterfall + chocolate

Breakfast at bread what what, Rios hand pies for the trail, Two Waters or Ma-Cu before 10:00, Cacao Trails (or the Kekoldi family), Finca la Isla in the afternoon, dinner at Grow.

1. ■ bread what what [Puerto Viejo]
2. ■ Rios Vegan Food [Puerto Viejo]
3. ● Catarata Finca Two Waters [Hone Creek / Bribri]
4. ● Catarata Ma-Cu (Bribri "Sparkling" waterfall) [Hone Creek / Bribri]
5. ◆ Cacao Trails — Museo de Cacao [Hone Creek / Bribri]
6. ◆ Kekoldi indigenous family — cacao and exotic animals [Hone Creek / Bribri]
7. ● Finca la Isla permaculture farm and botanical garden [Puerto Viejo]
8. ■ Grow Puerto Viejo [Puerto Viejo]

Puerto Viejo only

bread what what, browse town, Finca la Isla, beach at Playa Negra, dinner in town at Grow, Umi Rojo (sushi) or El Dragon — or La NENA on the way back.

1. ■ bread what what [Puerto Viejo]
2. ● Finca la Isla permaculture farm and botanical garden [Puerto Viejo]
3. ■ Grow Puerto Viejo [Puerto Viejo]
4. ■ Umi Rojo Beach House (ex-Chile Rojo) [Puerto Viejo]
5. ■ Restaurante El Dragon — Asian cuisine & Kung Fu Bar [Puerto Viejo]
6. ■ La NENA [Cocles]

Stay south

Refuge trail or Sherman's boat if not done Thursday, Moca Beach, dinner at Maxi's.

1. ● Gandoca-Manzanillo Wildlife Refuge trail [Manzanillo]
2. ○ Sherman's Boat Tour — dolphins, Punta Mona, snorkel [Manzanillo]
3. ■ Moca Beach Restaurant [Manzanillo]
4. ■ Maxi's Restaurant (Manzanillo) [Manzanillo]

07:00	Settle \$419.51 with Congo Bongo Office opens 07:00. Checkout day.	+506 8957 4177
15:30	Adobe return — Limón downtown Office closes 17:00. Return with a full tank.	+506 2758 4042
16:15	Sansa check-in (LIO)	
17:10	Sansa RZ1132 to SJO Alajuela City Hotel tonight.	

WATCH OUT All bags are in the car at Cahuita — paid lot at Kelly Creek, nothing visible. · Latest departure from Manzanillo direct to Limón: 13:45. · Saturday hours differ: Moca Beach closes 17:00, Rios Vegan closes 12:00.

Cahuita snorkel + walk

Leave 07:00, snorkel at 08:15, 45 min on the coastal trail, lunch in Cahuita village, leave 13:45, Adobe by 14:45.

1. ○ Cahuita National Park — reef snorkel by boat [Cahuita]
2. ● Cahuita National Park — coastal trail [Cahuita]
3. ◇ Cahuita village [Cahuita]

Cahuita walk only

Refuge dawn walk 06:30–08:00, leave 08:45, coastal trail 09:45–12:30, lunch in Cahuita village, leave 13:45.

1. ● Gandoca-Manzanillo Wildlife Refuge trail [Manzanillo]
2. ● Cahuita National Park — coastal trail [Cahuita]
3. ◇ Cahuita village [Cahuita]

Slow exit

Beach morning at Manzanillo, early lunch at Moca Beach (closes 17:00 Sat), leave 13:45 direct to Limón (1h15).

1. ○ DIY snorkel off Manzanillo beach [Manzanillo]
2. ■ Moca Beach Restaurant [Manzanillo]

Part III • What's closed today

KEY ✕ closed ✓ open, no fixed hours ? hours unknown Sorted north to south. Trip dates under each weekday.

PLACE	MON 5	TUE 6	WED 7	THU 8	FRI 9	SAT 10	SUN
CAHUITA							
● Cahuita National Park — coastal trail	8–16	8–16	8–16	8–16	8–16	8–16	8–16
○ Cahuita National Park — reef snorkel...	8–12	8–12	8–12	8–12	8–12	8–12	8–12
◇ Cahuita village	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
HONE CREEK / BRIBRI							
● Catarata Finca Two Waters	8–17	8–17	8–17	8–17	8–17	8–17	8–17
● Catarata Ma-Cu	8–17	8–17	8–17	8–17	8–17	8–17	8–17
◆ Cacao Trails — Museo de Cacao	8–16	8–16	8–16	8–16	8–16	8–16	8–16
◆ Kekoldi Reserve — chocolate...	8–14	8–14	8–14	8–14	8–14	8–14	8–14
PUERTO VIEJO							
● Finca la Isla permaculture farm and...	10–16	✕	✕	✕	10–16	10–16	10–16
■ Grow Puerto Viejo	12–21	12–21	12–21	12–21	12–21	12–21	✕
■ Rios Vegan Food	8–16	8–16	8–16	8–16	8–16	7–12	✕
■ bread what what	8–15	✕	8–15	8–15	8–15	8–16	8–16
■ Restaurante El Dragon — Asian cuisine...	17–22	17–22	17–22	17–22	17–22	17–22	17–22
■ Umi Rojo Beach House	17–22	✕	17–22	17–23	17–23	12–23	12–23
PLAYA CHIQUITA							
■ Spicy Coconut	12:30–21:30	12:30–21:30	12:30–21:30	12:30–21:30	12:30–21:30	12:30–21:30	12:30–21:30
COCLES							
● Jaguar Rescue Center	9–13	9–13	9–13	9–13	9–13	9–13	9–13
▲ Masajes Beauty Ritual Spa — couples...	8–21	8–21	8–21	8–21	8–21	8–21	8–21
■ La NENA	12–20:30	✕	✕	12–20:30	12–20:30	12–20:30	12–20:30
■ Zaika Indian Cuisine Bar & Grill	12–22	12–22	12–22	12–22	12–22	12–22	✕
■ Pita & Hummus House	7–21	7–21	7–21	7–21	7–21	7–21	✕
■ SAGE @ Playa 506	8–21	8–21	8–21	8–21	8–21	8–21	8–21
PUNTA UVA							
○ Río Punta Uva kayak + sloth walk	8–17	8–17	8–17	8–17	8–17	8–17	8–17
○ DIY snorkel at Playa Arrecife / Punta...	6–17:30	6–17:30	6–17:30	6–17:30	6–17:30	6–17:30	6–17:30
■ La Sirena	11–17	11–17	11–17	11–17	11–17	11–17	✕
MANZANILLO							
● Gandoca-Manzanillo Wildlife Refuge...	6:30–15	6:30–15	6:30–15	6:30–15	6:30–15	6:30–15	6:30–15
○ Sherman's Boat Tour — dolphins, Punta...	7:30–17	7:30–17	7:30–17	7:30–17	7:30–17	7:30–17	7:30–17
○ DIY snorkel off Manzanillo beach	6–17:30	6–17:30	6–17:30	6–17:30	6–17:30	6–17:30	6–17:30
■ Moca Beach Restaurant	7–21	7–21	7–21	7–21	7–21	9–17	7–21
■ Maxi's Restaurant	11–21	11–21	11–21	11–21	11–21	11–21	11–21

By arrangement only (no published hours): ◆ Punta Mona permaculture farm · ◆ Kekoldi indigenous family — cacao and exotic animals

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There is no text or other markings on the paper.

Hours, prices and phone numbers were correct when this guide was generated. Call ahead on anything that matters.